# የአይጦቹ ንጉሥ ልጅ

## The Rat King's Son

Review revision: PILOT-FAMILY-R1-2026-07-05-RAT-KING

Audience: ages 5-6

Origin basis: Oromia story narrated by Merga Debelo

Story pages: 14

## For adult family/cultural review

Read naturally with a child in one sitting. This reviews the story, not the child. Mark the page when wording changes aloud, attention drops, a transition feels rushed, or a moment creates confusion, fear, delight, prediction, or a request to continue.

Do not record a child's name, exact age, contact details, school, location, photo, audio, video, medical information, or other identifying details. Use the assigned anonymous session code and broad age band only.

This copy is not text locked. Illustration beats are planning notes, not final artwork.

# Story page 1

### Amharic

ከትልቅ ተራራ ሥር ብዙ አይጦች በአንድነት ይኖሩ ነበር። ንጉሣቸውም ልጁን እጅግ ይወደው ነበር።

### English

Beneath a great mountain lived a large community of rats. Their king loved his son very much.

### Illustration beat

Rat community beneath a mountain; king beside young prince.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 2

### Amharic

አንድ ቀን ንጉሡ “ልጄ ሲያድግ ጥሩ ቤተሰብ እንዲመሠርት እፈልጋለሁ። በዓለም ላይ ከሁሉ ታላቅ የሆነውን ቤተሰብ እንፈልግ” አለ።

### English

One day the king said, “When my son grows up, I want him to build a good family. Let us seek the greatest family in the world.”

### Illustration beat

King speaking to a circle of rat elders.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 3

### Amharic

ሽማግሌዎቹ “ከፈጣሪ የሚበልጥ ማን አለ?” ብለው ወደ ሰማይ ተመለከቱ። ንጉሡም “እንግዲያው ፈጣሪን እንጠይቅ” አለ።

### English

“Who could be greater than the Creator?” the elders wondered, looking toward the sky. “Then we shall ask the Creator,” said the king.

### Illustration beat

Elders gazing upward from the foot of the mountain.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 4

### Amharic

ፈጣሪ በትሕትና ሰማቸውና “ደመና ሲመጣ ሰማዩን ይሸፍናል። ምናልባት ደመናውን ትጠይቁ ይሆናል” አላቸው።

### English

The Creator listened kindly. “When Cloud arrives, it covers the sky. Perhaps you should ask Cloud,” came the answer.

### Illustration beat

A gentle cloud spreading across the sky.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 5

### Amharic

አይጦቹ ወደ ደመናው ሄዱ። “አንተ ከሰማይ ይልቅ ታላቅ ነህን?” ብለው ጠየቁት።

### English

The rats hurried to Cloud. “Are you greater than the sky?” they asked.

### Illustration beat

Tiny rat elders beneath a soft, low cloud.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 6

### Amharic

ደመናውም “እኔ ሰማዩን እሸፍናለሁ፤ ነፋስ ግን ሲነፍስ ይበትነኛል” አለ። “ከእኔ ይልቅ ነፋስን ጠይቁ።”

### English

“I can cover the sky,” said Cloud, “but Wind scatters me whenever it blows. Ask Wind, who is stronger than I am.”

### Illustration beat

Wind gently parting the cloud as rats hold their hats.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 7

### Amharic

አይጦቹ ነፋስን ተከትለው “አንተ ከሁሉ ታላቅ ነህን?” አሉት። ነፋሱ ዙሪያቸውን እየዞረ ሳቀ።

### English

The rats followed the breeze. “Are you the greatest of all?” they asked. Wind swirled around them with a laugh.

### Illustration beat

Playful wind curling around travelling rat elders.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 8

### Amharic

“ደመናን ማባረር እችላለሁ፤ ተራራን ግን ከቦታው ማንቀሳቀስ አልችልም” አለ ነፋሱ። “ከእኔ ይልቅ ተራራን ጠይቁ” አላቸው።

### English

“I can chase Cloud away,” said Wind, “but I cannot move Mountain from its place. Ask Mountain, who is greater than I am.”

### Illustration beat

Wind bending trees while the mountain stands calmly.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 9

### Amharic

ሽማግሌዎቹ ወደ ተራራው ቀርበው “አንተ ከነፋስ ይልቅ ታላቅ ነህን?” አሉ። ተራራውም በጥልቅ ድምፅ መለሰ።

### English

The elders stood before Mountain. “Are you greater than Wind?” they called. Mountain answered in a deep voice.

### Illustration beat

Rat elders at the immense but friendly mountain face.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 10

### Amharic

“ነፋስ አያንቀሳቅሰኝም፤ ነገር ግን ትንሹ የዱር አይጥ በውስጤ መንገድ ይቆፍራል” አለ ተራራው። “እርሱ የማልችለውን ይችላል።”

### English

“Wind cannot move me,” said Mountain, “yet a little bush rat digs pathways through me. He can do something I cannot.”

### Illustration beat

Cutaway view of a small bush rat making a tunnel.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 11

### Amharic

ሽማግሌዎቹ ተደነቁ። በጉዟቸው ሁሉ ከትልቅ ወደ ትልቅ ሲፈልጉ፣ መልሱ ከቤታቸው አጠገብ ነበር።

### English

The elders were amazed. They had travelled far in search of greatness, only to find the answer close to home.

### Illustration beat

Elders exchanging surprised smiles near the tunnel entrance.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 12

### Amharic

ወደ ንጉሡ ተመልሰው ያዩትን ሁሉ ነገሩት። “እያንዳንዱ የሚችለው የተለየ ነገር አለ” አሉት።

### English

They returned and told the king everything. “Each one has a different kind of strength,” they said.

### Illustration beat

Elders recounting the journey to king and prince.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 13

### Amharic

ንጉሡ ከዱር አይጦቹ ቤተሰብ ጋር ተዋወቀ። ልጆቻቸውም አብረው ሲጫወቱና ሲማማሩ ደስ አላቸው።

### English

The king met the bush-rat family. Their children enjoyed playing, learning, and spending time together.

### Illustration beat

Two rat families sharing food while the young rats play.

### Adult notes for this page

# Story page 14

### Amharic

ዓመታት ካለፉ በኋላ ልጆቹ አድገው ቤተሰብ መሠረቱ። ንጉሡም “ታላቅነት ሌሎችን በመብለጥ ሳይሆን ያለንን መልካም ነገር በማወቅ ነው” ብሎ ተማረ።

### English

Years later, the young rats grew up and made a family of their own. The king learned that greatness is not being above everyone else; it is recognising the good each one carries.

### Illustration beat

Grown rat couple with both families celebrating warmly.

### Adult notes for this page

# Session scorecard

Anonymous session code: _____ Broad age band: 3-4 / 5-6

Language: Amharic / English Adult role: parent / caregiver / educator / other

Completed story: Yes / No

Rate 1 (serious problem) to 5 (ready), or mark N/A.

| Measure | 1-5 | Page/evidence |
|---|---|---|
| Language sounded natural aloud | | |
| Sentences were easy to read | | |
| Child followed the story flow | | |
| Page pacing felt unhurried | | |
| Conflict felt emotionally safe | | |
| Ending felt clear and satisfying | | |
| Child remained interested | | |
| Illustration beats support understanding | | |

# Observations and recommendation

Words changed aloud; confusing or rushed pages; child questions; delight or prediction; fear or discomfort; remembered part; suggested revision:

Recommendation: Pass / Revise wording / Revise page flow / Reconsider age band / Cultural review / Safety review / Replace

Return this adult scorecard through the owner's private route. Remove identifying child details before submission.